

TAB 15



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-373-25/26, **Version:** 1

Agenda Date: 4/21/2026

In Control: Facilities

Project Approval for the 32nd Street School USC Magnet Major Modernization Project

Facilities Services Division

Brief Description:

(Project Approval for the 32nd Street School USC Magnet Major Modernization Project) Recommends approval of the 32nd Street School USC Magnet Major Modernization Project (Project) and authorize staff to execute all reasonable instruments to implement the proposed Project.

Action Proposed:

1. Approve the proposed 32nd Street School USC Magnet Major Modernization Project.
2. Authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or the Chief Facilities Executive and/or their designee(s) to execute all reasonable instruments to implement the proposed Project, including budget modifications and the purchase of equipment and materials.

The Office of Environmental Health and Safety's (OEHS) evaluation of the proposed Project resulted in the preparation of a Negative Declaration (ND). Pursuant to the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Guidelines, staff is requesting the Board of Education (Board) approve the proposed Project so that construction activities can commence at a later date. The proposed action may only be considered after the Board adopts the ND prepared by OEHS in compliance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines for the proposed Project. (Board Report No. 372-25/26).

Background:

On October 12, 2021, the Board approved the project definition for site due diligence, planning, and feasibility activities necessary to propose scope recommendations, budget, and schedule for the proposed Project. On November 14, 2023, the Board approved the project redefinition for the proposed Project to begin the environmental review, design, procurement, and other activities necessary to implement the proposed project. Subsequently, on November 19, 2024, the Board approved the Alternative Design-Build Contract Award to Charles Pankow Builders, Ltd. in partnership with QDG Incorporated (dba QDG Architecture) for Phase 1 of the contract to provide design and preconstruction services for the proposed Project, and on March 10, 2026, the Board approved a contract amendment to the Alternative Design-Build Contract to include Phase 2 construction services.

The proposed Project is located on a 3.67-acre school campus at 822 W 32nd Street in the City of Los Angeles (Board District 1, Region South). 32nd Street School USC Magnet (School) is a span school serving Grades K-12. All existing buildings were constructed between 1949 and 2010. As of the 2025-2026 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review (E-CAR), the School served approximately 900 students.

The proposed Project involves the modernization and enhancement of the School with the construction of new buildings and site improvements with approximately twenty-three general and specialty classrooms and support

spaces. The proposed Project also includes the demolition of thirteen uncertified relocatable buildings and one storage building.

Additional improvements encompass exterior painting of all remaining buildings to provide a uniform appearance; associated landscape, hardscape, and related infrastructure upgrades including a new electrical transformer. The proposed Project also includes accessibility upgrades to ensure compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) requirements, and local, state, and federal regulations.

To support the School during construction, the programs will temporarily relocate to the former Downtown Business Magnet (DBM) campus where interim facilities will be upgraded to include an elementary play area, exterior upgrades, and minor reconfiguration of existing demountable partitions.

The former DBM campus is located at 1081 West Temple Street, Los Angeles CA 90012, in Region East, and Board District 2 (Dr. Rocio Rivas). The campus was vacated by Downtown Business Magnet High School in the Summer of 2022 and most recently served as interim space for Rise Kohyang High School operated by Bright Star Schools. A portion of the site houses KLCS Education Foundation (KLCS), which will remain in place while the School temporarily occupies the site.

The intent of the major modernization project is to address buildings and grounds that pose a safety concern and have the greatest need for upgrades with emphasis placed on seismic safety, reducing Los Angeles Unified's reliance on relocatable buildings, and addressing the most critical/severe physical conditions. While the Project is extensive in nature, less critical items may not be addressed. This approach allows Los Angeles Unified to reach more schools with the limited funding available.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the proposed Project will permit construction activities to be undertaken once the Division of the State Architect (DSA) approval is secured. Construction is anticipated to begin in the second quarter of 2026 and be completed in the fourth quarter of 2028.

Board Options and Consequences:

Adoption of staff's proposal will permit Los Angeles Unified to proceed with the construction of the proposed Project after DSA approval is secured. If the proposed action is not adopted, staff will be unable to proceed with construction activities. As a result, the School will continue to operate with aging, deteriorating, and outdated buildings and grounds. Furthermore, students, staff and the community will not benefit from the significant facilities improvements that will be undertaken as part of the proposed Project.

Policy Implications:

This action helps facilitate the Facilities Services Division Strategic Execution Plan and supports the goals and objectives of the School Upgrade Program (SUP). The proposed action advances Los Angeles Unified's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan, Pillar 4 Operational Effectiveness, Modernizing Infrastructure by upgrading facilities to support the instructional program.

Budget Impact:

The proposed action does not have a budget impact as the Board previously authorized funding for the proposed Project when it approved the Project definition and authorized the alternative design-build contract award. The current budget for the proposed Project is \$107,959,859. The proposed Project is funded by Bond Program funds targeted in the SUP for major modernizations, upgrades, and reconfigurations to school

campuses.

Student Impact:

The proposed Project will help ensure that approximately 900 existing and future students attending the School are provided with safe and updated facilities that support learning.

Issues and Analysis:

OEHS evaluated the proposed Project to determine potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of the ND. Los Angeles Unified circulated the IS/ND for a 30-day public review period from January 15, 2026 to February 17, 2026. The analysis documented in the IS/ND found that the proposed Project would not result in significant environmental impacts as a result of construction or operation of the proposed Project with the implementation of LAUSD Standard Conditions of Approval. Pursuant to State CEQA Guidelines, prior to the proposed Project proceeding into construction, the Board must adopt the ND and subsequently must approve the proposed Project.

Attachments:

None

Submitted:

03/26/26

RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ANDRES E. CHAIT
Acting Superintendent

APPROVED BY:


PEDRO SALCIDO
Deputy Superintendent
Business Services and Operations

REVIEWED BY:

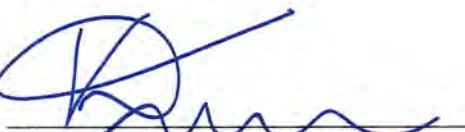

DEVORA NAVERA REED
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☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


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